

Lab: Listening to What Wants to Happen

Objective

Explore embodied planning through reflective journaling that reveals how the body anticipates, prepares for, and evaluates future action through the lens of pattern-feeling without numbers.

Prerequisites

- A quiet, comfortable space for 25 minutes
- Willingness to engage in reflective journaling
- No prior experience required

Part 1: Arriving (5 minutes)

Sit quietly with your journal. Take three slow breaths. Before writing anything, check in with your body. Notice any sensations, feelings, or subtle knowings that are present right now.

Notice: your body is already planning. It is adjusting posture, regulating breath, and anticipating what comes next. Through pattern-feeling without numbers, attend to the body's forward-looking quality.

Write your response here

(What is your body preparing for right now? What future does it seem to anticipate?)

Part 2: Felt Futures (7 minutes)

Think of two possible activities. For each, let the body simulate the experience. Through pattern-feeling without numbers, notice the somatic response -- does the body lean toward one future or pull away?

Write your response here

(Describe the bodily response to each imagined future. Did the body have a preference? How did pattern-feeling without numbers inform this evaluation?)

Part 3: Emergent Action (7 minutes)

Rather than planning what to do next, ask the body: What wants to happen? Wait. Let a movement or action emerge without deliberation. Through pattern-feeling without numbers, trust the body's intelligence.

Write your response here

(What emerged? Was there a sense of rightness or flow? How does pattern-feeling without numbers support or challenge this kind of emergent planning?)

Part 4: Reflection (5 minutes)

Through pattern-feeling without numbers, reflect on the relationship between planning and presence.

Write your response here

(Can you plan without projecting anxiously into the future? How does embodied planning through pattern-feeling without numbers differ from intellectual planning?)

Reflection Table

Dimension	What I Noticed	Active Inference Connection
Initial awareness		Baseline generative model state
Embodied exploration		Prediction error through direct experience
Pattern-feeling without numbers lens		Course-specific perspective on planning
Integration		Updated understanding through bodily knowing

Discussion

Consider how pattern-feeling without numbers reveals aspects of planning that other perspectives might miss. In Active Inference, every perspective changes the precision weighting of different signals, revealing different dimensions of the same underlying process of free energy minimization.